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Tatebe returns; blanks Osaki

Powered by the strong, three-hit pitching of H. Tatebe and a first inning rally, the Bermudas shut out the Osaki SP division 4-0 on Saturday. The performance was Tatebe's strongest to date. He struck out seven and walked none en route to his first victory since being sidelined with a leg injury two months ago.

The Bermudas took no time in drawing first blood, scoring two quick tallies in the top of the first. Ohashi was hit by a pitch, stole second, and then third. After Fraker popped weakly to thirdbase, Shiose ~~doubled~~ ^{singled} Ohashi home with the game's first run. It was to be all the Bermudas and Tatebe needed. The rejuvenated southpaw, batting cleanup, then stroked a triple to right-center, thus closing the scoring for the next six innings.

The Osakis nearly took advantage of some sloppy fielding in their half of the first, putting men on second and third with one out. Tatebe's peg to firstbase was dropped by Abuta (returning to action after a long absence), thus allowing Fujimoto a free base after he had dribbled the ball in front of home plate. Fujimoto promptly stole second. After Nakayama k'd (the first of three whiffs in the inning), Narita sent a shot to Fraker at third, who seemed to blink at the ball. It bounced high off his thigh, and when it finally came down, Fujimoto easily evaded his tag, reaching third safely. The Bermudas' early lead seemed in jeopardy when Narita swiped second, but Tatebe rose to the occasion, fanning Okano and Kanai to snuff the rally.

From then on it was smooth sailing for the Bermudas, who are now ^{6 2}~~8-1-1~~ for the season. After surrendering an opening single in the second, Tatebe proceeded to retire the next 16 batters, allowing only a harmless single with two gone in the seventh. He struck out two in the third and two more in the final frame to complement his first inning triplet.

The Bermuda hitters were themselves dormant until the seventh, when they added two insurance runs. Abuta, who had doubled to left, scored on Fraker's infield single. Ohashi, who had singled Abuta to third before Fraker's RBI hit, later was forced home when the Osaki pitcher, Suzuki, walked Tanaka. Suzuki allowed seven free passes in the game, while striking out three.

Afterwards, the victory was toasted with beer and gyoza in the Bermudas' favorite Chinese restaurant. The team is now resting for this Saturday's big game with MITI. The match should prove to be their biggest challenge since they fell, sans Tatebe, in the third round of the Sankei tournament, in May. But there will be one difference next time out: Tatebe is back.

「野球上達法」(ベースボールマガジン社) 持っている方、塩瀬迄返却して下さい。

Notes to article:

en route=on the way

sidelined=put out of action

draw first blood=to act first, as in a sword fight.

tally=point

rejuvenated=newly young (or, in this case, recovered)

sloppy=bad, messy.

peg= throw

dribble=to hit weakly.

whiff=strikeout

swipe=steal

fan=strikeout (verb)

snuff=extinguish, put out.

triplet=a collection of three things; here, three strikeouts.

dormant=sleeping, in hibernation.

free pass=base on balls, a walk.

"sans"=French, for "without". It's sometimes used in English.

Bermudas 2 0 0 0 0 0 2 4 7/5 (麻布学園グランド)
大崎SP 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0

バツ-9	守備	打数	得点	安打	打点	盗塁	四球	三振	SP	守備	打数	得点	安打	打点	盗塁	四球	三振
1 大橋	捕	2	2	1	0	3	2	0	藤本	捕	3	0	0	0	1	0	0
2 Paul	三塁	4	0	1	1	1	0	0	中山	一塁 中堅	3	0	0	0	0	0	2
3 塩瀬	中堅	3	1	1	1	2	1	0	成田	遊	3	0	1	0	1	0	0
4 建部	投	3	0	1	1	0	1	0	岡野	三塁	3	0	0	0	0	0	2
5 小林	遊	3	0	0	0	0	1	0	金井	中堅 一塁	3	0	1	0	0	0	1
6 田中	二塁 左翼	3	0	0	1	0	1	1	近松	右翼	3	0	1	0	0	0	1
7 内山	右翼	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	吉川	左翼	3	0	0	0	0	0	0
8 樋口	左翼	2	0	0	0	0	0	2	大井	二塁	1	0	0	0	0	0	0
古川 ⁽⁵⁰⁾	二塁	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	山下 ⁽⁴⁰⁾	一塁	1	0	0	0	0	0	0
9 油田	一塁	2	1	1	0	1	1	0	鈴木	投	2	0	0	0	0	0	1
合計	/	27	4	5	4	7	7	3	合計	/	24	0	3	0	2	0	7